



◀ **TEARS** *With every blink, watery tears wash bacteria off the surface of your eyes. Tears also contain lysozyme, a chemical that destroys the cell walls of bacteria.*

WOW!

Not all bacteria are bad. Your skin is home to millions of friendly bacteria that help protect you from the bacteria that cause disease.

Your skin's outer layer consists of dead cells packed tightly together, forming a very tough barrier. Germs cannot get through this unless your skin is cut.

In your intestines, any germs that survive the stomach's acid bath are attacked by the digestive juices that break down food.

FEVER

When harmful bacteria or viruses multiply inside you, they cause what doctors call an infection. Your body reacts to infections by heating up, raising your temperature above the normal 98.6 °F (37 °C). This reaction, called fever, helps stop the germs from multiplying. It also boosts the activity of germ-killing white blood cells.

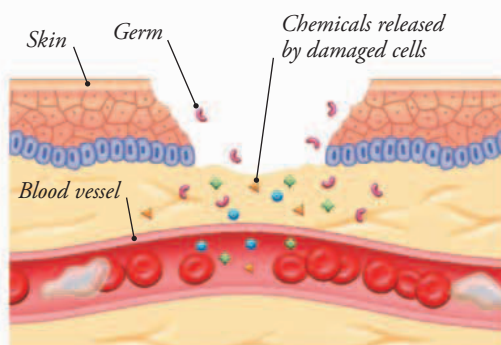


▲ **MEASURING TEMPERATURE** *A mother uses a digital thermometer to check whether her daughter's temperature is higher than normal, indicating that she may have an infection.*

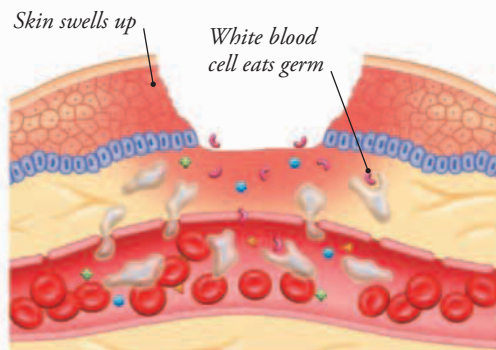
SWELLING UP

If your skin gets cut, germs can get into your body. To block their path and limit damage, the skin reacts by becoming inflamed (swollen). Blood vessels under the skin become wider and

let blood leak out, so that germ-eating white blood cells can kill the germs. The area around the cut becomes swollen and red. The skin feels painful and hot as the wound is healing.



▲ **DAMAGE** *A cut in the skin allows germs to invade. Damaged cells release chemicals that attract germ-destroying white blood cells.*



▲ **RESPONSE** *Blood vessels widen and allow blood cells to pass out. White blood cells flock into the wound to seek out and destroy the germs.*